

# Zombie USMCA will endure through Trump

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## 【要点】

- ・トランプ大統領の任期中、「ゾンビUSMCA」シナリオ（新たな三国間協定がなく、米国の関税除外が継続される状態）が80%の確率で続く見通しである。
- ・米国とメキシコは年末までに自動車鋼鉄関税の軽減を提供する限定的な通商協定を締結する可能性が65%であるが、両国の政治状況により米国とカナダの協定は2026年中の実現が困難である。
- ・フランスのル・ペン候補による5年間で1800億ユーロの歳出削減計画は市場からの支持を得られる可能性は低いが、2027年度予算案の採択を認める方針を示唆している。
- ・トランプ大統領はイランの爆撃を検討しており、中間選挙後の米国とイランの軍事的緊張が高まるリスクが増加している。

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## 【メール原文】

A Zombie USMCA scenario is likely to endure through the rest of US President Donald Trump's term.  
French presidential frontrunner Marine Le Pen's plan|||||||

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summary

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A Zombie USMCA scenario is likely to endure through the rest of US President Donald Trump's term.

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French presidential frontrunner Marine Le Pen's plan to curb spending is unlikely to win over markets.

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US-Iran escalation risks will increase after midterms, with a protracted standoff remaining the most likely scenario through year-end.

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EG is upgrading El Salvador's short-term trajectory to positive on a more flexible IMF.

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Countries and sectors in this edition of the Daily Brief include the US, Brazil, Canada, El Salvador, France, Iran, Mexico, Saudi Arabia, South Africa, Yemen, Geoeconomics, and trade.

the top line

US, Canada, Mexico, Trade—Zombie USMCA will endure through Trump's term

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A “Zombie USMCA” scenario, with no new trilateral agreement and continued exemptions under the United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement (USMCA) from US Section 301 tariffs, is likely to persist through the rest of Trump’s term (80% probability).

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The US and Mexico are likely to conclude a limited trade deal that would provide relief from US sectoral tariffs on autos and steel (65% odds) by year's end; however, a US-Canada agreement in 2026 remains unlikely (40%), given the political conditions in both countries, although a major escalation is also unlikely.

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Auto manufacturing, the most integrated sector in North America, faces the highest risk of US tariff divergence between Canada and Mexico in our basecase; elsewhere, North American trade integration will likely continue broadly unchanged, with Ottawa and Mexico City able to rely on the Comprehensive and Progressive Agreement for Trans-Pacific Partnership (CPTPP) as a bilateral free trade backstop.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:unitedstates@eurasiagroup.net) .

France—Le Pen's €180 billion bid for fiscal credibility falls flat

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Le Pen’s plan to shore up the country’s tottering finances by cutting €180 billion from state spending over five years may gain some support from voters but is unlikely to win over markets, based on the initial reactions of opponents and independent economists.

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However, at her Tuesday press conference, Le Pen offered her strongest indication to date that she will allow the adoption of an “imperfect” state budget for 2027 this fall to avoid a bond market crisis.

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EG continues to assign a 35% probability to a victory for the far-right leader and a 40% chance to the centrist candidate Edouard Philippe.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [europe@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:europe@eurasiagroup.net) .

US, Iran—Escalation risk ticks up as Trump ponders bombing after midterms

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Both Iran and the US are preparing for a significant escalation in the conflict (35%, up from 25%), given the lack of progress around a deal (10%, down from 15%).

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A protracted standoff remains the most likely scenario (55%, down from 60%) through the rest of the year, due to the risks both sides face in significantly escalating.

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Iran will maintain pressure on the US with more aggressive strikes on shipping, while the US will consider escalation options after the midterm elections—if regional output falls due to Iranian attacks, the case for US escalation will strengthen.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [mena@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:mena@eurasiagroup.net) .

France, Geoeconomics—Chart of the Day

El Salvador—IMF breakthrough lifts short-term trajectory as harder reforms get deferred

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President Nayib Bukele's administration unlocked its frozen IMF program after the fund showed flexibility on key structural issues, including pensions and bitcoin, improving the short-term trajectory from neutral to positive.

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Bukele will likely address pension-related debt equal to about 5.5% of GDP before the grace period expires in April 2027, but revised program terms will allow him to delay more difficult structural reforms until after the February election, in which Bukele will easily win a third term.

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The long-term trajectory remains neutral, though it is close to positive, because uncertainty persists over Bukele's willingness to pursue a politically sensitive pension reform and a civil service overhaul, both of which are key to maintaining IMF support and broader disbursements from international financial institutions.

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Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:latinamerica@eurasiagroup.net) .

upcoming conference calls

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14 October 10:00 AM ET—Israeli elections outlook. Register here .

eg in brief

Saudi Arabia, Yemen—Conflict update: The Saudi-backed campaign in Yemen is underperforming relative to official claims because the Houthis retain control of Bab el-Mandeb, have made gains in Taiz, and will continue attacking Saudi infrastructure regardless of battlefield developments. Saudi Arabia faces a three-front threat from Houthis to the south, Iraqi militias to the north, and Iran to the east, which one speaker characterized as an existential risk to the kingdom. Normalization between Saudi Arabia and Israel is not dead but remains contingent on Israeli concessions to the Palestinians, and Riyadh may seek to join the Abraham Accords before Trump leaves office if Israeli elections produce a more amenable government. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [mena@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:mena@eurasiagroup.net) .

Brazil—Jair Bolsonaro likely to be released if son wins: The Federal Supreme Court will likely suspend or overturn former president Jair Bolsonaro's conviction if his son, Flavio Bolsonaro, is elected (70% odds). The former president is likely to be freed before the 5 January inauguration, though the criminal review could push his release until later in 2027. Jair Bolsonaro will become a central political adviser to his son's administration, and clashes between that government and the courts are unlikely to undermine economic reforms. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:brazilresearch@eurasiagroup.net) .

South Africa—A conversation with Mmusi Maimane on the local government elections: Coalition politics is now structurally locked in for South Africa; the African National Congress (ANC) is polling in the low 30s and no path back to a majority is visible in the near term. The ANC's post-election leadership race is

accelerating; a disruptive succession contest to play out in early 2027, not 2028. Bold structural reforms—fewer provinces, bigger metros, redesigned municipal finance—are needed to lower economic drag and energize voters. Read more here . Reach out to discuss: [africa@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:africa@eurasiagroup.net) .

Upcoming events:

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8 October: Central bank decision: Uruguay.

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9 October: Data: Brazil and Russia CPI, and US UMich consumer sentiment.

The EG Daily Brief is compiled by Jens Larsen, Lucy Eve, Babak Minovi, Pietro Guglielmi, Rahul Bhatia, Martina Silva, Marianne Moreira, and Trista Kelley.

We love feedback! Send us a note at [DailyBrief@eurasiagroup.net](mailto:DailyBrief@eurasiagroup.net) .

closing quip

"The parties that are part of the system put us in the hands of lenders but I refuse to lie to the French by saying this all will not have consequences,"—Le Pen said at a press conference on her fiscal plan on 6 October.

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